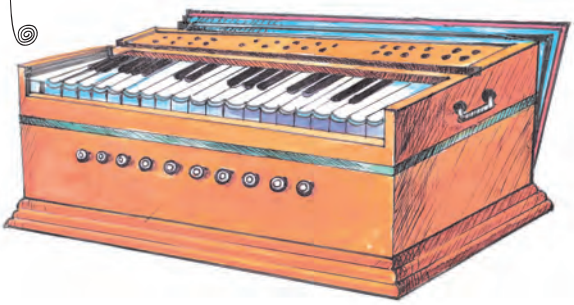
4. Instrumental Music

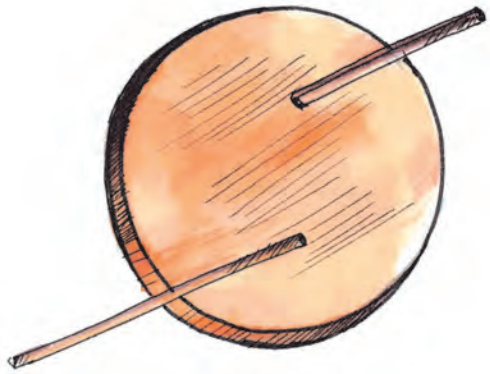


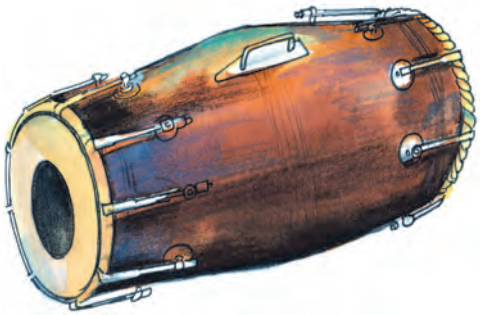
Introduction to Instrumental Music

Geeta, a sweet and good girl, was always quiet. She did not talk much to anyone. Did not play. Always sat pondering over something. She liked to listen to the rustling of the leaves. Whether it was the drip drop of falling water drops or the sound of the weaver bird knocking on the bark of a tree, she would be engrossed listening to these with her heart and soul. She would think about how the tinkling sound of small bells in our temple at home and the loud ding-dong sound of the school or temple bell were produced. She could not understand how when different things clashed or when two things were banged on each other, different sounds were generated.

With these questions in mind she went to her music teacher in school. The music teacher explained to her very nicely. "Look Geeta,

- The instruments which are played with the help of wind are wind instruments.
- The leather clad instruments are percussion instruments.
- The instruments which have strings are called string instruments.
- When some solid instruments are played by clashing on each other they are called solid or non-membranous percussion instruments.





These include cymbals (*zaanj*), *taal*, castanets (*chiplya*), *lezium*, *tiprya*, bell, triangle, tambourine (*khanjiri*), etc.

When you drop a pebble in still water, small waves are created. In the same way, sound waves are produced by these instruments. Therefore, we are able to hear the sounds of the instruments. The speciality of these instruments is that sound is created when they are struck. These instruments are used to play accompaniments.

While telling her about the instruments the teacher took her to the music classroom. The whole room was filled with instruments and she could see various types of instruments there. *Tabla,* harmonium, *dholki, sitar,* flute, *taal,* cymbals *(zaanj), tiprya,* tambourine (*khanjiri) lezium,* violin, bugle, conch, clarion *(sanai),* sarangi,…Oh my God! Will I remember the names of so many instruments? Friends, let's see if you can tell the names of the instruments you see in the pictures.

- Tell the names of the instruments after the students have carefully observed them. If possible, let them handle the instruments. They should be introduced to the instruments available in school.